WILD RICE TAMALES
WITH SMOKED MUSHROOMS AND ROSE HIP

makes about 20 tamales

To showcase two important foods for Indigenous peoples in the region—wild rice and nixtamalized corn—I bring them together in tamales, with the cooked rice blended into the masa. I then stuff the tamales with quickly smoked mushrooms that get a bright citrusy note from rose hips and serve them along a sweet-tart berry sauce known as wóžapi, sometimes spelled wojapi.

Between mixing the dough, cooking the filling, and stuffing the corn husks, tamales can be labor-intensive to pull together on your own. That's why people typically make them in big batches while in community with each other. (If you want to do the same, feel free to double or even triple the recipe.)

You'll need to soak 1 pint of wood chips overnight and soak 24 corn husks for at least 4 hours or up to overnight (plus more for steaming). While you can use any type of wood chips designed for smoking, I like the clean flavor of oak with the mushrooms.

MUSHROOM FILLING

- 2 pounds oyster mushrooms, cleaned and cut into ¼-inch slices
- 1 tablespoon Rose Hip Powder (page 359) or store-bought
- Sea salt

TAMALES

- 2 pounds Fresh Masa (page 28) or use masa harina (see chart, page 27)
- ⅔ cup sunflower oil or melted and slightly cooled duck fat
- 2 teaspoons fine sea salt
- ½ cup Roasted Bird Stock (page 40) or other stock
- 2 cups cooked wild rice (from ¾ cup uncooked rice; see page 83)
- 24 corn husks, soaked for 4 to 24 hours
- Mixed Berry Wóžapi (recipe follows) for serving

Make the mushroom filling: Line a metal roasting pan with aluminum foil. Arrange the soaked wood chips in the pan. Cover the chips with foil and poke holes in the foil.

Arrange an ovenproof perforated pan or fine-mesh rack so it's about 2 inches above the chips. (You can create balls of foil to help elevate the rack.) Spread out the mushrooms on the rack and cover the pan with foil. Set across two burners over high heat for 7 minutes. Turn off the heat and let it stand for 10 minutes. (Alternatively, spread them out on two baking sheets without oil and roast in a 400°F oven until they're wilted, 12 to 15 minutes.)

Uncover the mushrooms, transfer to a cutting board, and finely chop.

Toss the mushrooms with the rose hip powder and season well with salt.

Make the tamales: In a stand mixer fitted with the paddle attachment, combine the masa, oil, and salt and beat on medium speed for about 5 minutes, or until fluffy. Start adding the stock, 1 tablespoon at a time, until you have a soft, slightly tacky dough. Use a spoon or your hands to mix in the wild rice. Arrange 1 soaked corn husk on a work surface with the narrow end pointing away from you and the ribbed side down. Using a ⅓-cup measure, scoop the dough into the center of the husk. Use a large rounded spoon to create a well in the dough, leaving a ½-inch border of husk. Measure out about 3 tablespoons of the mushrooms and arrange in the well.

Fold in the long sides of the husk, overlapping them to enclose the filling. Fold the narrow end toward you, over the tamal; it will remain open at the wide end. Stand the tamal, open-end up, in a very

large steamer insert. Repeat with the remaining corn husks, dough, and filling.

Cover the tamales with more corn husks or parchment paper.

Fill the bottom of the steamer with water so it's below the bottom of the steamer insert. Bring to a boil over high heat, then reduce the heat to low. Cover the steamer with a lid and steam the tamales for 1½ hours, replacing water if needed. To check doneness, remove one of the tamales; if it feels firm, check inside. If it looks shiny and wet or you see a lot of residue sticking to the husk when you pull it away, continue cooking for up to 30 minutes longer. Otherwise, remove all the tamales from the steamer to cool for 15 minutes. The masa inside will continue to firm up during this time.

Serve the tamales with wóžapi.

MIXED BERRY WÓŽAPI

Makes about 2 cups

- 2 cups mixed berries, thawed if frozen
- 1 tablespoon maple syrup

In a medium saucepan, combine the berries and ¼ cup water. Cook over medium heat, stirring, for 3 to 5 minutes, until the berries are softened. Transfer to a blender, add the maple syrup, and puree until smooth.

Transfer to an airtight container and refrigerate for up to 4 days.

ON MASA HARINA

Masa harina allows you to make masa more easily at home. The flour, made from nixtamalized, dehydrated, and ground corn, lets you just add water. For many years, Maseca was the only widely available brand of masa harina, but you can now find better-quality versions online and at some markets.

Masienda (masienda.com), for example, makes masa harina from four different colors of corn, all sourced from heirloom corn grown in Mexico. Bob's Red Mill makes their masa harina from organic yellow corn and King Arthur Flour uses organic white corn.

You can make any of the recipes in the book that call for fresh masa using masa harina. Below are some rough equivalencies. Know that when you use masa harina, you might often end up with a little extra than what's called for in the recipe, but that's okay.

FRESH MASA (by WEIGHT)	MASA HARINA	FINE SEA SALT	WARM WATER
8 ounces	1 cup	pinch	¾ cup
1 pound	1¾ cups	¼ teaspoon	1⅓ cups
1½ pounds	2½ cups	⅜ teaspoon	2 scant cups
2 pounds	3½ cups	½ teaspoon	2⅔ cups

THE METHOD In a bowl, stir together the masa harina and salt, then add the warm water. Knead to form a soft dough, making sure no dry spots remain. Cover and let stand for 20 minutes to 1 hour to allow the flour to fully hydrate before using the masa.

You might need to add a little more water or masa harina to achieve the proper texture, which will depend on the recipe.